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Report: Invasive species

Q1) Does FRich, FEve and FDis decline or increase with invasion success?

Ans: Based on the model summaries and FD plots, FRic, FEve and FDis of the native community do not systematically decline or increase along the invasion success gradient.

Q2) Do CWM traits shift toward a fast or conservative strategy along the invasion gradient?

Ans: Across all treatments combined, the CWM models do not show a strong, statistically significant global shift toward fast or conservative strategies along the invasion gradient.

- Within the drought treatment specifically, the graphs indicate that with higher invasion success:
    - CWM LDMC decreases (faster leaves) and
    - CWM height increases (taller plants).

So, only in drought plots do CWM traits of natives clearly tend toward a somewhat faster, taller strategy with increasing invasion success; in other treatments, CWM traits remain roughly stable along the invasion gradient.

Q3) What does this imply about mechanisms of invasion resistance?

Ans: The results imply that, in this experiment, mechanisms of invasion resistance in native plant communities are not explained by declines in FRic, FEve, or FDis, but are instead linked to shifts in dominant functional traits (CWM), especially under drought. Trait dominance and filtering of natives by the invasion–drought combination appear more important than changes in functional diversity indices themselves.